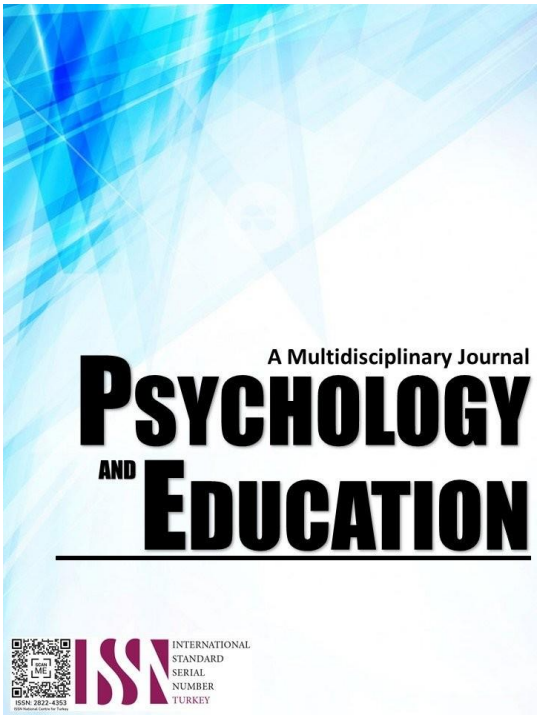
THEOLOGICAL VIRTUES: FOUNDATION OF THE FAMILY VALUES



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Research Article

Theological Virtues: Foundation of the Family Values

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Abstract

This study explores the interplay between theological virtues—faith, hope, and charity—and their role in shaping and sustaining fundamental family values. Grounded in theological and philosophical perspectives, the research examines how these virtues influence familial relationships, moral development, and overall societal well-being. Faith fosters spiritual unity and resilience within the family, instilling trust and shared moral convictions. Hope cultivates perseverance, optimism, and emotional strength, enabling family members to navigate challenges with a sense of purpose and confidence. Charity, as the highest virtue, promotes selflessness, compassion, and unconditional love, reinforcing the bonds of kinship and social harmony. By analyzing theological doctrines, ethical teachings, and empirical studies on family dynamics, this paper highlights the significance of these virtues in strengthening the moral foundation of the family unit. It also underscores their role in fostering responsible parenthood, ethical decision-making, and harmonious relationships. The study further discusses contemporary challenges that threaten family values, including materialism, individualism, and secular influences, while proposing ways to reintegrate theological virtues into modern family life. The findings suggest that families that consciously practice and cultivate theological virtues tend to exhibit stronger interpersonal bonds, ethical integrity, and resilience in times of crisis. The research emphasizes the necessity of religious and moral education in nurturing these virtues and preserving family values across generations. Ultimately, this study advocates for a holistic approach in promoting theological virtues as a cornerstone of family stability and societal progress.

Keywords: *theological values, family, virtues*

Introduction

Having a family is not an accident nor a chance. It is man's participation to the plan of God. Indeed, it is already existed from the beginning of human history. The family is the foundation of the good values and moral values for the young people. The family is the place where values are built. The family functions as ideals and standards that govern the actions of the young people who continue their journey in life.

A child learns his/her behaviors, attitudes, and dispositions by modelling what he/she sees around his/her family. Family plays a significant role in developing the social, psychological, and spiritual of the child. If the family values are not totally grounded in the Theological Virtues, which are Faith, Hope, and Love, family cannot be called an ideal family and Christian family.

Furthermore, the focal point of this paper is about family and its values in view of the Theological Virtues. This paper is the synthesis of the current situation of the family, its values, and its foundation. To be guided for this paper, these are the several questions and queries that need to reflect upon. What is now the current situation of the family when it comes to its values? What are the factors which can lead the collapse of the family values? How can be the Theological Virtues become the foundation of the Family?

The scope and limitation of this paper focuses only on the family level and discuss the Theological Virtues as foundation of the family values. To give us clear, this paper is merely qualitative and systematic. The researcher must explain the current situation of the family by presenting and showing some data and statistics. On the other hand, when explaining the Theological Virtues, the foundation of the researcher is the Sacred Scripture and the Magisterium of the Church.

Since this paper is about family, the researcher must focus the Calling of Abraham particularly how he forms his own family. In the New Testament, the Holy Family is the highlight, which is the Model of the Theological Virtues. For the Teaching of the Church, the Amoris Laetitia will be using also by the researcher as support to the discussion of this paper especially when he gives his own personal interpretations or hermeneutics on his Theme which is the Theological Virtues as the Foundation of Family Values.

To understand the main goal and objective of this study, there are some necessary terms that need to be defined and clarified so that the reader can comprehend and understand the expositions of the researcher when he discusses the Theme of his paper. Below are the following terms:

Theological Virtues are the three virtues of faith, hope, and charity (love) as defined by St. Paul. They relate directly to God. They dispose Christian to live in a relationship with the Holy Trinity. They have the One and Triune God for their origin, motive, and object (CCC#1812).

Faith is the theological virtue by which we believe in God and believe all that he has said and revealed to us, and that Holy Church proposes for our belief, because he is truth itself. By faith "man freely commits his entire self to God." For this reason, the believers seek to know and do God's will. "The righteous shall live by faith (CCC# 1814)."

Hope is the theological virtue by which we desire the Kingdom of heaven and eternal life as our happiness, placing our trust in Christ's promises relying not our own strength, but on the help of the grace of the Holy Spirit. "Let us hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering, for he whom promised is faithful" (CCC # 1817).

Charity (Love) is the theological virtue by which we love God above all things for his own sake, and our neighbor as ourselves for the love of God (CCC#1822). Jesus makes charity the new commandment. By loving his own to the end, he makes manifest the Father's love which he receives. By loving one another, the disciples imitate the love of Jesus which they themselves receive (CCC#1823).

Family Values are like personal values or work values, but they include the entire family. Regardless of what your family looks like, how many parents and children it may (or may not include), these values inform family life and how you deal with challenges as a unit.Family is a term that derive from the Latin word, famulus, servant, and familia, household servants, or the household.

Results and Discussion

Historical Context or the Christian Faith Experiences/Challenges

Families right now experience many problems, different issues, and concerns within the family. In the most certain cases, certain problems can even lead to estrangement. Broken family is one of the issues and concerns that cause the estrangement between family members. Frank Anderson, MD, who is a psychiatrist and psychotherapist, and specializes in the treatment of trauma, says that "A broken family is one that includes unhealthy or severed relationships within the family unit." For Frank Anderson, family is often associated with divorce but certainly can occur in an intact family where various members conflict with or estrangement from each other.

For Ruksana Saikia, to be broken in the family, there must be crises which are arisen out of misconception, misunderstanding, and mistreating. The family members are staying away from each other. The occurring crises lead to the divorce of the parents, disposal of sons and daughters, and leaving home by any members of that family. It is very controversial that whether to claim every splitting up is broken family, while they are still run the family well. Indeed, according to Ruksana Saikia, there are many families without father, mother, and other members yet they are still functional. Although they are likely broken, of course, they are not broken rather just some members are left away.

Causes of Broken Family

Parental or friends influence considers to be one of the main reasons why family is broken. When a third party has involved itself in the matters inside the home, bad-mouthing will just likely to happen, and misunderstanding will only grow worse. There are many cases that parents are splitting up due to the influence of friends. In fact, the members of family constitute the child's first environment and are the most significant people during the early years of life. The kind of family where they grow up may affect their development by determining the kind of relationship which they share with different family members.

Children are the ones who suffer most of broken family. The effect is directly to them. When a couple split up, it is the children who are affected spiritually, physically, emotionally, and socially. Supposedly, the family is the place for the children where they can receive love, and concern from their parents. Moreover, in the broken family, children are normally growing up with having low and bad manner. Children who make trouble, rivalry, discontentment in the school or other gathering places are usually coming from broken family.

Students from broken family have problems which can affect their academic performance, self-confidence, and behaviors. One main factor that affects how well or how badly students react to the trauma of separation is self-confidence (Child Family Blog Editor, 2019). Traumatic family background is often an inner critic who conveys one is not good enough, or an inner voice, which continually puts one down and belittles one's needs (Johnson,2020). Statistics shows that 30 percent more of the students from broken family have many absences, being late, and skip classes than those stable families. Students from broken family are more rebellious, exposing to drugs, alcohol drinking, and smoking (Mackay, 2005).

Fallet (2017) states that students from broken family are more engaged in sexual activities where teenage pregnancy commonly occurs. According to Morin (2019), researches have shown that students from broken family can easily experience depression and anxiety. It has been found out also that more than 20 percent of the children from broken family are mostly affected on their psychological health.According to the Very Well Family article, distress from broken homes also develops behavioral issues that affect social skills and the emergence of a problem with peers.

On the other hand, there are also positives experiences of students from broken family. According to Wood (2019), parent's separation has a positive effect on the students. For example, students from broken family are more eventually empathetic to others and understand since they believe that people are not the same. In Education respectively, morals and values are present as well. Moreover, Lopez et al. (2018) states that the problem's response varies with such difficulty students face. Some students struggle with their issues; voicing and sharing thoughts with peers is their coping way. Some students are put their trust in God, accepting, and moving forward.

A recent study from Korea proves that students from broken family can be promising in other things like sport. The study shows that

student-athletes from broken family are assertive and hardworking during their practice. They also excel at finding solutions to overcome their difficulties with their chosen sports (Shin and Kim, 2019). Halligan et al. (2014) explains that broken families can be favorable because they are released from the problems develop from a dysfunctional family relationship. From three hundred and thirty-six respondents, who are most of them undergraduates, receive positive changes to their lifestyle.

Moreover, broken family can be led to the distraction of family values. Elkind says that many parents now place their need for self-realization and self-fulfillment before the needs of family as a unit. Elkind is very clear to his understanding that parents nowadays invest less of themselves in their children even if they spend more money on them. Unlike in 1960's, parents can spend more time to their children, for example, 10-12 hours a week. The contemporary parental style choices that serve the need of parents are more important rather than those of their children.

Biblical Foundation of the Theological Virtues

The Story of Abraham

The entire story of Abraham was presented in two major themes: First, God made a promise to Abraham, which will control all the events narrated in the Pentateuch, but which already began to unfold in Abraham's own lifetime; second, God blessed Abraham and made him specially chosen friend because Abraham was faithful to God.

Promise and Covenant

The Abraham cycle has connected the promised of land and a son to a series of covenants, or formal agreements, between Yahweh and Abraham. In Genesis 12 and 15, they are free gifts of God very much like the royal grants of kings to favorite courtiers. In Genesis 17, it uses the language of mutual obligation treaties more typical of the Sinai covenant in Exodus 19-24.

To emphasize the importance of this theme, God announces his promise in the very first scene (Gen 12:2-3):

"I will make of you a great nation; I will bless you and make your name great so that you will become a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and curse those who curse you. And all the peoples of the earth shall bless themselves in you."

The second major covenant scene came from the Book of Genesis 17:5-7.

"I will make you a father of many nations. I will make you very fruitful; I will bring nations out of you, and kings shall descend from you. I will establish my covenant between you and me and your descendants after you for all generations as an everlasting covenant to be your God and the God of your descendants after you."

God freely offers Abraham the promise of an heir who will find a great nation and the promise of land, but God can only bring these about if Abraham and Sarah trust enough. This brings us to the second major theme of the Abraham stories: his faithfulness to God's promise. It summed up in Genesis 15:6, "Abraham believed the Lord, who credited it to him as righteousness." But Biblical Tradition does not make Abraham a perfect person without any flaws.

In Gen. Chapter 12 and 20, he tries to save his own life by giving up his wife Sarah and thus risking the promise of a son. In Chapter 16, he is uncertain enough to take a slave girl in order to gain a son. In Chapter 17, he doubts the Angel who tells him that Sarah will bear a child. But these are rare moments in a life that stands open to God's direction. For one thing, Abraham always worships Yahweh wherever he stops on his travels- at Bethel in Chapter 12, at Hebron in Chapter 13, at (Jeru) Salem in Chapter 14.

Abraham always accepts God's command to move on, and frequently has face to face experiences of God (chapters 15, 17, and 18). In a moment of great sorrow, he obeys God and sends off his son Ishmael to a new life in order to prevent any threat to Isaac (Chapter 21).

What follows, in Genesis 17 and 18, is stunned disbelief of both Abraham and Sarah, and how God will prove to them that there is nothing impossible for Him. God promises a son through Sarah, but Abraham is too old to believe that. Abraham pleads with God to bless his son with Haggar, Sarah's maidservant, rather than filling him with false hope. God's response makes Abraham's heart warm with hope. In Genesis 17:19, God says "No, but Sarah your wife shall bear you a son, and you shall call his name Isaac. I will establish my covenant with him as an everlasting covenant for his offspring after him."

The system of covenantal symbolism between God and Abraham would take a new form and substance when the family of Abraham and Sarah is finally completed with the birth of Isaac, the son of the promise. Isaac has become the living proof both for Abraham and Sarah that God is perfectly capable keeping His promises, no matter how impossible they seem.

Abraham the Faithful

The Sacrifice of Isaac is Abraham's perfect response to the Theophany (Gn. 22:1-18). When Isaac reached his boyhood, he would play essential part in bringing to a climax the saga's narrative of the covenantal bonding between God and Abraham.

The Book of Genesis Chapter 22 starts when God has decided to put Abraham to the test. God has called Abraham's name twice and he has promptly responded, and God informs him that he is to take his only son and beloved son and offers him as sacrifice in the land

of Moriah. Abraham without any question and complaint makes the necessary preparation to comply with this drastic divine order.

Abraham has accompanied by Isaac and some servants set out with the same total trust in divine providence as he does when God guides him from Haran to Canaan. After Abraham has found the location which God has chosen for the holocaust, he leaves his servants and goes alone with his young son to the place of worship. When Isaac questions his father about the victim for sacrifice, Abraham expresses his faith that God would take care of providing one.

Upon their arrival at the designated place for the sacrifice, Abraham prepares the altar and lay his bound son on top of the wood. Then, he reaches out and seizes a knife to kill Isaac. At this dramatic moment of truth, the messenger of the Lord calls his name twice and forbade him to touch the boy because Abraham has passed the test which is given by God to him. He proves his fear to God and his willingness to offer his only son as a sacrifice to him.

The whole story sums up perfectly the character of Abraham as the man of faith. In Islamic traditions he still called Khalil Allah, which means "the friend of God." Even in the New Testament, St. Paul cites Abraham as a model of faith in Romans 4: 1-25 and in Galatians 3:6-9.

The Holy Family: Radiates the Example of True Love

Luke mentioned that Joseph went from the town of Nazareth in Galilee to Judea, to the city of David that was called Bethlehem. According to the Gospel of St. Luke, Joseph went with his wife Mary who was pregnant to be registered because he was of the house and family of David.

Luke portrayed the prophet Simeon as:

He came in the Spirit into the temple; and when the parents brought in the child Jesus to perform the custom of the law regarding him, he took him into his arms and blessed God saying:

"Now, Master, you may let your servant go in peace, according to your word. For my eyes have seen the salvation which you prepared in the sight of all the peoples, a light for revelation to the Gentiles and Glory for your Israel (Lk.2:25-32)."

Luke finally mentioned at this episode in the life of the Holy Family, the eighty-four-year-old prophetess Anna who live in the Temple, praying and fasting. Luke stated that coming forward she gave thanks to God and spoke about the child to all who were awaiting the redemption of Jerusalem (Lk. 2:36-38).

Luke ended his narrative of Jesus' early life with the dramatic visit of the Holy Family to Jerusalem. That was the time when Jesus was only twelve years old. This episode emphasized once more that Jesus' parents, Mother Mary and Joseph, had to become Jesus' disciples if they were to fulfill their responsibility as his parents. Luke described the event in the following words:

Now it was the practice of his parents to go to Jerusalem every year for the Passover festival. And when Jesus was twelve, they made the pilgrimage as usual. When the festive season was over and they set off for home, the boy Jesus stayed behind Jerusalem. His parents did not know of this but supposing that he was with party, they traveled a whole day and only then they began looking for him among their friends and relations (Lk 2:41-44).

When the parents of Jesus could not find him, they returned to Jerusalem to look for him. After three days, they found Him sitting in the temple surrounded by the teachers listening to them and putting questions. And all who heard him were amazed at his intelligence and the answers which He gave. His parents were astonished to see him there and His Mother said to him:

My Son why have you treated us like this? Your father and I have been anxiously searching for you? Why did you search for me? He spoke. Did you not know that I was bound to be in my Father's house? But they did not understand what he meant. Then, he went back with them to Nazareth and continued to be under their authority. His mother treasured up all these things in her heart. As Jesus grew, he advanced in wisdom and in favor with God and men (Lk. 2:45-52).

The Holy Family here becomes a model of every Christian family in the dynamism of Christian radical conversion which brings Christian Integrity of life and love. Mother Mary and Joseph, as well as Jesus, recognized that the most important value in their family life was the concrete will of God in the life of each member of their family and the family as a whole. In a word, they were to become perfect Christic stewards and peacebringers.

In the reflection of Pope John Paul II during the Feast of the Holy Family, he says that today's liturgy relates the invitation of the Angel addressed twice to Joseph: "Rise, take the child and his mother, and flee to Egypt… for Herod is about to search the Child, to destroy him" (Mt. 2:13); and after Herod's death: "Rise, take the child and his mother, go to the land of Israel" (Mt.2: 19).

In this account, according to Pope John Paul 11, we can perceive two decisive moments for the Holy Family: first, in Bethlehem, when King Herod wants to kill the Child because he sees him as rival to the throne, and in Egypt, when the danger has passed, the Holy Family can return to Nazareth from their exile. First, we observe God's fatherly care, the divine solitude of the Father for the incarnate Son, and almost as a reflection of its Joseph's human concern. Beside him, we perceive Mary's silent, anxious presence. In her heart, she is meditating on God's concern and Joseph's prompt obedience. We call this solitude of God Divine Providence while human

concern could be defined "human providence." It is in virtue of this "providence" that those who are parents endeavor to avoid every kind of evil and to provide their children and family with every possible good.

The Holy Family of Nazareth is an example for all Christian and human families. It radiates genuine love and charity, not only creating an eloquent example for all families, but also offering the guarantee that such love can be achieved in every family unit. According to the pope, may those who are engaged to be married be inspired by the Holy Family in their preparation for matrimony; may spouses look to it as they build their domestic community. May faith grow and may love, harmony, solidarity, mutual respect and openness to life reign in every home.

Magisterial Teaching: Amoris Laetitia

In the opening paragraphs, Pope Francis gave us great hope that we were about to read a document that was true reflection of the modern Church and the families we love:

Each country or region, moreover, can seek solutions better suited to its culture and sensitive to its traditions and local needs. (Sec.3)

But as we journeyed through Amoris Laetitia, we found the document lacking a true understanding of our world, our community, and our families-perhaps the voices of experience were missing from the conversation. Perhaps, we were hoping for something that would at least leave the door open and offer a sign of hope for those trapped in marriages as victims of abuse, and the childless couple.

The synod process allowed for an examination of the situation of families in today's world, and thus for a broader vision and a renewed awareness of the importance of marriage and the family. (Sec. 2)

Pope Francis writes about the lived experiences of families today, mentioning the many challenges faced by refugee and migrant families, the confusion caused by rampant individualism and the ideological denial of differences between men and women, the damage inflicted by pornography and child abuse, and the special needs of parents with children with disabilities. The pope is reminding us that there is (#57) "no stereotype of the ideal family, but rather a challenging mosaic made up of many different realities, with all their joys, hopes and problems."

And then the Holy Father states what he wants to do in this document:

"The situations that concern us are challenges. We should not be trapped into wasting our energy in doleful laments, but rather seek new forms of missionary creativity. In every situation that presents itself, the Church is conscious of the need to offer a word of truth and hope. The great values of marriage and the Christian family correspond to a yearning that is part and parcel of human existence. If we see any number of problems, these should be … a summons to revive our hope and to make it the source of prophetic visions, transformative actions, and creative forms of charity.""

When Pope Francis speaks about the pastoral care needed in the Church for persons in broken families, he underlines the need to be with them (#291):

"… the Church must accompany with attention and care the weakest of her children, who show signs of a wounded and troubled love, by restoring them hope and confidence, like a beacon of a lighthouse in a port or a torch carried among the people to enlighten those who have lost their way or who are in the midst of a storm."

"Love in marriage" begins with an engaging reflection on the Biblical passage on love found in 1 Corinthians 13:4-7: "Love is patient, love is kind; love is not jealous or boastful …". Listen to just a little of what the Holy Father says about patience in his Apostolic Exhortation (#92):

"We encounter problems whenever we think that relationships or people ought to be perfect, or when we put ourselves at the center and expect things to turn out our way. Then everything makes us impatient, everything makes us react aggressively. Unless we cultivate patience, we will always find excuses for responding angrily. We will end up incapable of living together, antisocial, unable to control our impulses, and our families will become battlegrounds. … Love always has an aspect of deep compassion that leads to accepting the other person as part of this world, even when he or she acts differently than I would like."

Pope Francis encourages family members (#323), "to contemplate our loved ones with the eyes of God and to see Christ in them." Then, he closes with this helpful perspective (#325):

"No family drops down from heaven perfectly formed; families need constantly to grow and mature in the ability to love. … All of us are called to keep striving towards something greater than ourselves and our families. … May we never lose heart because of our limitations, or ever stop seeking that fullness of love and communion which God holds out before us."

Pope Francis says that in the family, three words need to be used frequently —

"Please," "thanks" and "sorry": "In our families when we are not overbearing and ask: 'May I?'; in our families when we are not selfish and can say: 'Thank you'; and in our families when someone realizes that he or she did something wrong and is able to say 'Sorry!', our family experiences peace and joy. Let us not be stingy about using these words, but keep repeating them, day after day. For certain silences are oppressive, even at times within families, between husbands and wives, between parents and children, among siblings. The

right words, spoken at the right time, daily protect and nurture love."

We also find precious references to the family as a witness of faith among its members and mankind:

"The work of handing on the faith to children, in the sense of facilitating its expression and growth, helps the whole family in its evangelizing mission. It naturally begins to spread the faith to all around them even outside the family circle. Children who grew up in missionary families often become missionaries themselves; growing up in warm and friendly families, they learn to relate to the world in this way, without giving up their faith or their convictions" (AL 289).

Amoris Laetitia offers the vision of a pastoral and merciful Church that encourages people to experience the "joy of love." The family is an absolutely essential part of the Church, because after all, the Church is a "family of families" (80). The PCP II pp. 145 #421 clearly states that:

"Jesus began his work of salvation within a family, the Holy Family of Joseph, Mary and Jesus Himself. Thus, family life in the Lord is of greatest concern to the Church. The family plays a pivotal role in renewing Christian Life and in forming communities of the Lord's disciples; the family is where the journey in faith- life is initiated and guided toward maturity."

Pope John Paul II once says, "It is through the family that the history of salvation of the Church is wrought." He also adds that "the future of evangelization rests in great part on the Church in the home."

Hermeneutics:

Broken family can be defined as unhealthy relationship among the family members. Usually, in broken family, there is quarrel, misunderstanding, disharmony, disconnectedness, and chaos. Family relationship is seemed totally collapsed and stumbled. Family members are splitting up and the children are left behind. Husband and wife are parting their ways, and do not care from each other. The family is no longer functional. Hatred, jealousy, envy, and greed are present in the broken family. In society and school, the troublemaker is usually coming from broken family.

These are the common observations and scenarios of having a broken family. It seems there is no Hope, no Faith, and no Love anymore. On the other hand, there are families although they are somehow broken, they are still functional. Broken family due to unhealthy relationship must need help. The only way to restore and connect the broken family is God Himself, the source of the Theological Virtues which are Faith, Hope and Love.

Man of Faith is the perfect character of Abraham. His faith in God can be the concrete example of the broken family. Every broken family is living in different conditions and situations. It means to say that each broken family has unique and different experience in life. But what matters is the Faith. God must be the epitome and center of the family. Without Faith, how the broken family can live and see the vision of God since Faith is defined as the real experience of God. Sometimes, broken family can be used by God to have Faith in Him, since the family is a masterpiece of God. Faith in God makes the broken family more resilient. Just like Abraham, he puts his trust and surrenders everything to God.

Moreover, there are families which are somehow broken, but the relationship is healthy. They keep the unity and harmony in their family. Through their Faith in God, they go to Mass. They always pray. They participate when there is activity in the Church. They actively participate in various Ministries of the Church. They involve and engage themselves in the Charitable Works of the Church. They are more responsible, loyal, contented, compassionate, and committed when they are taking care their family members.

Hope must be the source and the foundation of the broken family. Hope makes the broken family more hopeful since God can do miracles anytime. Just like in prayer, if the broken family has Hope in God, there is patience and humility. God doesn't want to be boxed. He can work in a mysterious way even if there is chaos, troubles, challenges, disunity in your family. As what God says, "Be Still, I am who I am." Yes, it is true that there has no perfect family, but it doesn't mean there is no Hope in God. God can keep and fulfill His promise as what he does to Abraham.

Indeed, there are childless couples who remain faithful to their partner. They are hopeful and still waiting the miracles of God since they believe that God's blessing will come with its perfect time. There are family members who are not living together but they keep their promises. The husband is working abroad, and the wife is the one who takes care the family. Yet, long distance relationship is not the hindrance for them. What makes them stronger is their hope to keep always their promise.

God is love (Deus Caritas Est). God's love can be manifested in the life of the Holy Family which is the bedrock of the broken family. According to the anonymous author, "The hands of God are the hands of suffering. The hands of God are the hands of praise, but always the hands of love." Just like the Holy Family, the broken family may continue to live the love of God since God is the source of love. Sometimes, God is silent when our family is in trouble, in doubt, and during the shadow's moment. Although God is silent sometimes, His love is still working in our broken family. There is a saying which says "when there is love, I can wait to talk about…everything is sound.

What makes family is broken is the structural sins that present in the human society. Through greed, envy, anger, pride, and immoral acts, the family becomes disconnected and broken from the Love of God. But God has come into the world through the coming of His

Son Jesus Christ, the Christic Peace. Jesus is the One who can heal and restore the wound of the broken family, since He is the bringer and restorer of peace, the "shalom and Eirene." Shalom implies the personal restoration of the self while Eirene is the restoration of the broken fraternal relationship, including family relationship. "God loved the world so much that He gave His one and only Son, so that whoever believes in Him should not perish but instead have everlasting life" (John 3:16).

The Love of God is very vast and wide. It has no limit and can penetrate even to the deepest ocean. The Love of God is not only for the few but for all. This is not only for the unbroken family, but this is also for the broken family. The only thing to appreciate the Love of God is the acceptance that your family is broken. You need his love so that you can be more courageous, humble, and persistent in life. However, there are some couples who also try to live the love of God. Although they are not living together, the husband and wife always keep their love. Their love makes their relationship well-founded, stronger, and more meaningful since it is anchored in God's Love.

Indeed, the Hope, Faith, and Love of God to human being especially to the broken families have never faded. God is always there for them. God is never lost His Hope, Faith, and Love to the broken families. He remains humble and patient despite the unworthiness of the broken families just like Abraham. God's Hope, Faith and Love to the broken families signify that He is the merciful God who are always ready to embrace His lost sheep. God knows that His sheep needs Him. The broken family needs Him.

The broken family is impossible to restore if without the help of God. The broken families must allow the Holy Spirit to work on them since He is the continuing presence of Christ, the "shalom" and the "eirene" and the fullness of Revelation. The presence of Jesus can be manifested in the mission and journey of the Church. The Church is the place where the broken family can nurture and experience more their Faith, Hope, and Love in God. The Church is always ready to embrace the broken family since her mission is to bring and proclaim the Gospel and the Joy of Love with Hope and Faith.

Conclusions

God must be the fortress and the foundation of the family through living the Theological Virtues. If there is Faith, Hope, and Love in the family, the family may remain firm and continue to live the different values like respect, trust, loyalty, gratitude, and commitment. If the family misses to live the Theological Virtues, there is a tendency that the family might be broken and disoriented.

Through living the Theological Virtues, the family must be the source of hope. The young people can only achieve their goal and can have meaningful life if the source of their strength is their family which inspires them always to move forward despite the challenges that they may face in their life.

Through living the Theological Virtues, the family must be the source of faith. The family is a place where the family members learn to listen, to understand, to reflect, to meditate, to forgive, and to pray. To err is human to forgive is divine. Prayer must be learned first from the family.

Through living the Theological Virtues, the family must be the source of love. The family must be a place for love, and a place for peace. The family members must learn how to love and how to sacrifice for one another and must radiate that love to others within line to the redemptive Mission of the Church, particularly in the Apostolic Exhortation of Pope Francis, the Amoris Laetitia which is the joy of love.

Through the Theological Virtues, the broken family can be restored and with the help and guidance of the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit is the continuing presence of Jesus though the Church. The Church continues to proclaim Christ particularly to the unbroken and broken families. It is in the Church where the broken families can find their rest and where they can understand and nurture more the Theological Virtues, Hope, Faith, and Love.

To nurture the Theological Virtues in the family, these are the best recommendations that can passively strengthen the family relationship:

Go to Mass together. It will help reinforce your family values and bring each member of your family closer to God. It can also provide your children with a sense of community

Practice always the prayer life. A family that prays together stays together. The parents must teach their children how to pray and how to make the sign of the Cross, how to pray the Holy Rosary.

Engage and participate always in the Church Activities

Interact with other Christian families like Couples for Christ

Help the children to grow in freedom, maturity, overall discipline, and real autonomy

Parents must work actively to train and form their children in Christian Faith and character.

Parents must become the pastors of their children psychologically, socially, morally, and spiritually.

Always express love to each other. Expressing your love will bring joy and invite the Holy Family's Spirit into your home

Spend mealtime together. Try to gather your whole family around the table during dinner time. Eating together during mealtime can help and build better relationships in the family. It is a way for families to engage and connect with one another.

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